

Cat Attachment Grief Guide — Action Checklist

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RECOGNIZE CAT AFFECTION SIGNALS

- ☐ **Recognize the slow blink as a trust signal:** when your cat slowly closes and opens her eyes while looking at you, she's expressing love in the most deliberate way cats know how.
- ☐ **Notice if your cat follows you from room to room at a distance, because this shadowing behavior means she's invested in you and wants to know where you are at all times.:** Notice if your cat follows you from room to room at a distance, because this shadowing behavior means she's invested in you and wants to know where you are at all times.
- ☐ **Identify head-butts as scent-marking declarations:** when your cat bumps her head against you, she's claiming you as hers in the most feline way possible.
- ☐ **Respond to extended meow conversations by engaging back, since cats only meow to humans and this is her way of trying to communicate with you directly.:** Respond to extended meow conversations by engaging back, since cats only meow to humans and this is her way of trying to communicate with you directly.

DECODE CAT BODY LANGUAGE

- ☐ **Read tail positions to understand emotional states:** an upright curved tail means curiosity and friendliness, while a puffed tail signals fear and requires giving her space.
 - ☐ **Watch ear positioning for emotional cues:** forward-facing ears indicate interest, while flattened ears suggest fear or annoyance that you should respect by backing off.
 - ☐ **Understand that belly exposure is a trust gesture, not an invitation to pet:** when she shows you her most vulnerable area, she's demonstrating trust that touching breaks.
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- **Practice slow blinks with your cat daily by softening your eyes, looking at her calmly, and slowly closing your eyes; this daily practice builds a mutual language of trust that deepens your bond.:** Practice slow blinks with your cat daily by softening your eyes, looking at her calmly, and slowly closing your eyes; this daily practice builds a mutual language of trust that deepens your bond.

NAVIGATE YOUR ADJUSTMENT

- **Accept that grieving your old life with its freedom and quiet doesn't mean you made a mistake:** it means you're adjusting to a major life change while still loving your cat.
- **Follow the 30-day respect protocol by not reaching for, picking up, or pursuing your cat:** let her come to you on her own terms so she builds trust at her own pace.
- **Track weekly progress by noticing small signs of growing comfort like longer slow blinks, more time out of hiding, and closer approach distances that confirm the bond is forming.:** Track weekly progress by noticing small signs of growing comfort like longer slow blinks, more time out of hiding, and closer approach distances that confirm the bond is forming.
- **Recognize the difference between adjustment pain and genuine mismatch:** gradual cat comfort plus frustration about expectations signals normal adjustment, while severe allergies, insufficient space, or unresolvable conflict may mean the home isn't right.

Companion to the full guide in your Lemon Squeezy library — check off each item as you complete it.